

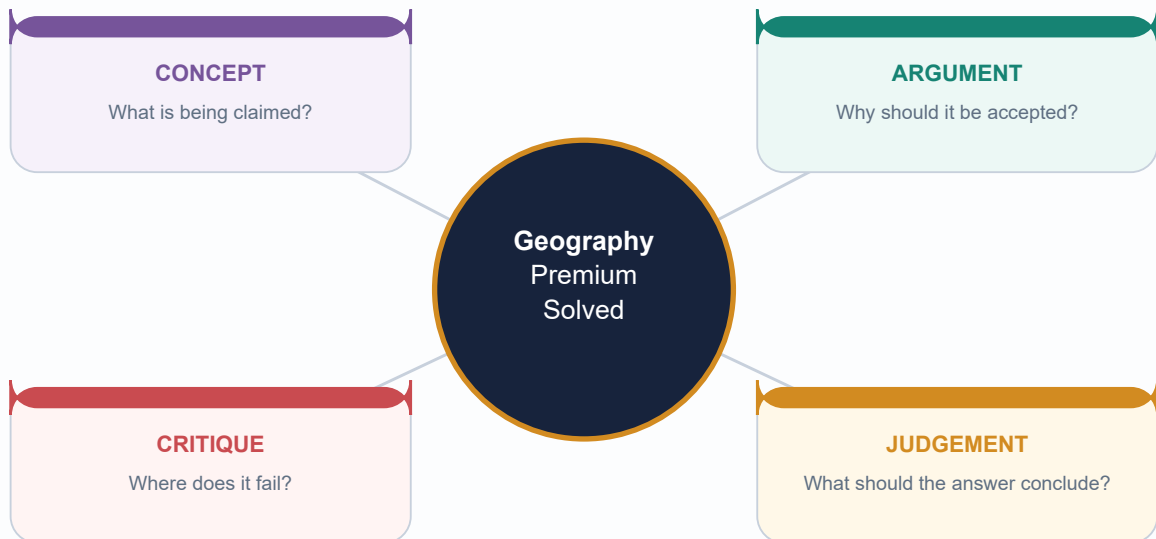
SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Geography 26 - Premium Solved Workbook

Geography 26 | Export date: 19 August 2026

Evidence cut-off and retrieval date: 19 August 2026

Generated for review | Approval status: NOT APPROVED



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Workbook protocol - provenance, key status and rotation

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

This workbook separates authentic UPSC PYQs from original practice. Authentic wording and option order are preserved; only original MCQs follow strict continuous A -> B -> C -> D answer rotation.

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Model answers are audited against the same five-part spine.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

KEY DATA

Practice layer	Status rule	Validation
2019/2021/2024 Mains PYQs	Verified from local official question-paper scans	Exact directive, marks and word limit retained
2024 Prelims Q41 and Q67	Verified from local official paper and Set-A key	Official keys D and A
Original MCQs Q1-Q44	Original, not PYQs	Strict keys A,B,C,D repeated 11 times
Original Mains	Original 10/15/20 markers	Model uses claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict
Missing objective key protocol	INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED	Not required for included 2024 PYQs

STATIC THEORY

- Never alter an authentic PYQ's option order to satisfy answer rotation.
- An inferred key, if ever unavoidable, must state confidence, elimination and absence of an official key. No such key is used here.
- All current figures in explanations carry instrument, reference date and estimate/projection status.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Retrieval and evidence audit date: 19 August 2026.
2. Workbook is generated for review and remains not approved.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Treat a plausible coaching key as official.

CORRECT: Use the official key or label inference explicitly.

WRONG: Rotate authentic PYQ options.

CORRECT: Rotation applies only to original MCQs.

MAINS ANGLE

Use the answer spine printed in Visual 24 for every Mains response.

STUDY LINK

Official UPSC local scans; package source register.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Verified PYQ 1 - 2019 GS-I

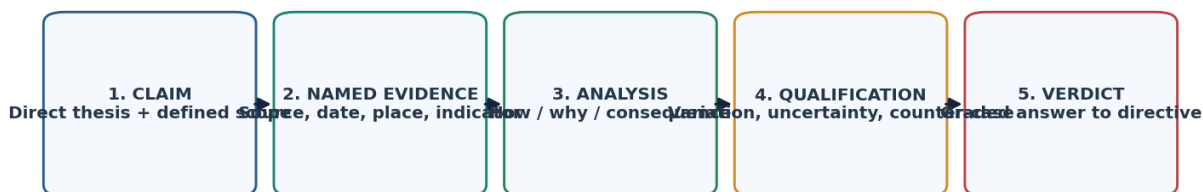
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

"Empowering women is the key to control population growth." Discuss. (UPSC GS-I 2019, Q9, 10 marks, 150 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: "Empowering women is the key to control population growth." Discuss. (UPSC GS-I 2019, Q9, 10 marks, 150 words)

- Demand and thesis: Women's empowerment expands informed choice and changes the survival, education, work and bargaining pathways that shape fertility, but it is central rather than singly sufficient.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Education and later marriage raise knowledge and agency. NPP 2000 places women's empowerment and child health in its strategy; school quality and continuity still determine actual capability.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Voluntary contraception allows preferences to be implemented. NFHS-6 (2023-24) reported CPR 69.1% with TFR 2.0; survey association does not identify one causal programme.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Work and asset rights can increase bargaining power, yet PLFS June 2026 CWS female LFPR was 32.7%, showing that demand, safety and care constrain the channel.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Child survival and social security reduce insurance motives, while son preference can persist after family-size decline.

- Qualification: The phrase 'control population' risks treating women as instruments; reproductive health must be voluntary, informed and free from target pressure.

- Verdict: Empowerment is the durable core of fertility transition when combined with survival, services, decent work and social protection.

- Why this earns marks: The answer discusses both force and limits of the proposition, uses three named Indian anchors, explains mechanisms and corrects coercive framing.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

Empowerment is the durable core of fertility transition when combined with survival, services, decent work and social protection.

STUDY LINK

Women empowerment; health; NPP 2000; labour.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Verified PYQ 2 - 2021 GS-I

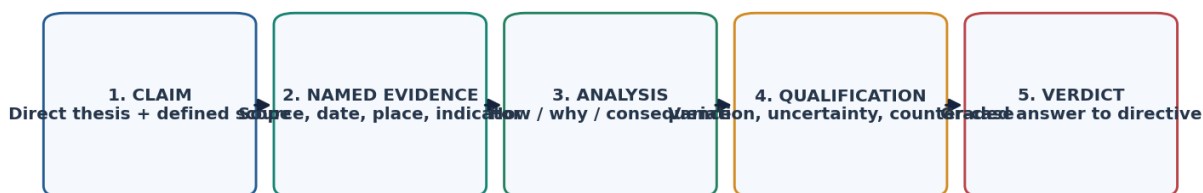
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Discuss the main objectives of Population Education and point out the measures to achieve them in India in detail. (UPSC GS-I 2021, Q18, 15 marks, 250 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Discuss the main objectives of Population Education and point out the measures to achieve them in India in detail. (UPSC GS-I 2021, Q18, 15 marks, 250 words)
- Demand and thesis: Population education should build demographic, reproductive, gender, environmental and data literacy so citizens can exercise agency and institutions can plan across the lifecycle.
- Objective -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Scientific reproductive-health literacy should cover puberty, consent, contraception, spacing, infertility and maternal/child health. NPP 2000's unmet-need focus supports service-linked learning, not target propaganda.
- Objective -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Gender literacy should address son preference, child marriage and unpaid care. NFHS-6 offers current survey evidence, but content must respect state and social diversity.
- Objective -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Demographic literacy should explain fertility, mortality, migration, ageing and dependency; WPP projections must be labelled by variant.
- Objective -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Resource literacy should combine Malthus, Boserup and IPAT so population is not blamed without examining consumption and access.
- Measures: age-appropriate curriculum, trained teachers and counsellors; adolescent-health links; ASHA/Anganwadi/community media; parent engagement; privacy and anti-discrimination safeguards; Census/SRS/NFHS data exercises; learning and service-access monitoring.
- Qualification: Education cannot substitute for accessible health, school, care and employment services; content must avoid coercive small-family messaging.
- Verdict: Population education should enable informed life choices and collective planning, not manufacture compliance with a numerical population target.
- Why this earns marks: It fully separates objectives and measures, uses policy/data anchors, includes implementation and safeguards, and ends with a rights-based judgement.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

Population education should enable informed life choices and collective planning, not manufacture compliance with a numerical population target.

STUDY LINK

Population education; rights; data literacy.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Verified PYQ 3 - 2024 GS-I

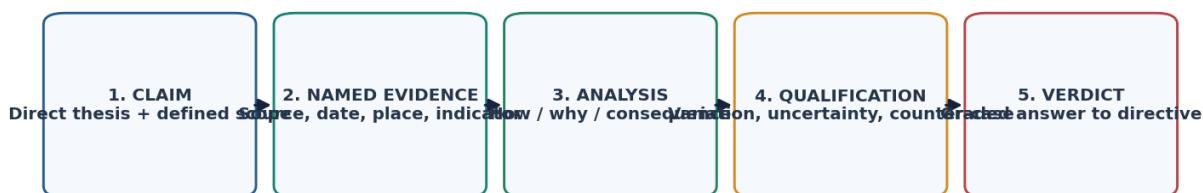
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why do large cities tend to attract more migrants than smaller towns? Discuss in the light of conditions in developing countries. (UPSC GS-I 2024, Q5, 10 marks, 150 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Why do large cities tend to attract more migrants than smaller towns? Discuss in the light of conditions in developing countries. (UPSC GS-I 2024, Q5, 10 marks, 150 words)

- Demand and thesis: Large cities exert cumulative attraction because agglomeration creates thick labour, service and network markets, even when actual living conditions are costly and insecure.

- Claim -> evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification: Large diversified labour markets offer formal and informal work. Delhi NCR, Mumbai, Bengaluru and Surat provide multiple entry sectors; Harris-Todaro expected income can attract migrants despite unemployment.

- Claim -> evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification: Agglomeration supplies transport gateways, education, hospitals, finance and administrative access. Access is unequal and peripheral residents may face long commutes.

- Claim -> evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification: Migrant networks lower information, housing and job-search costs, producing cumulative causation. Networks can also segment workers by origin, caste and gender.

- Claim -> evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification: Primacy and uneven regional investment weaken small-town opportunity. Urban growth still includes natural increase and reclassification, not migration alone.

- Qualification: Congestion, rent, pollution and informality can redirect movement to peri-urban areas or secondary cities; statistics may undercount circular migrants.

- Verdict: Large-city attraction in developing countries reflects opportunity concentration and network effects, but balanced regional development and serviced secondary cities can reduce distress without restricting mobility.

- Why this earns marks: It applies named migration theory, gives India-centric examples, distinguishes attraction from welfare and qualifies the migration-only explanation.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

Large-city attraction in developing countries reflects opportunity concentration and network effects, but balanced regional development and serviced secondary cities can reduce distress without restricting mobility.

STUDY LINK

Geography 27 migration and Geography 28 urbanisation.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Verified PYQ 4 - 2024 GS-I

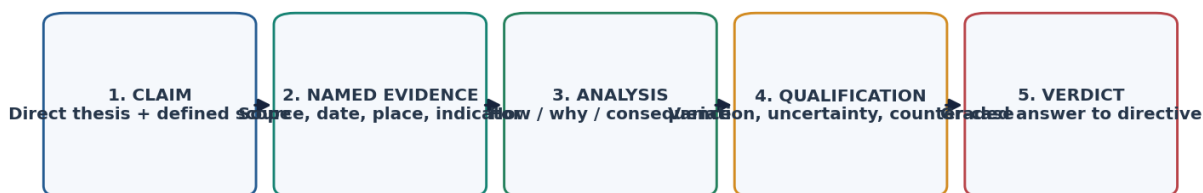
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

What is the concept of a 'demographic winter'? Is the world moving towards such a situation? Elaborate. (UPSC GS-I 2024, Q7, 10 marks, 150 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: What is the concept of a 'demographic winter'? Is the world moving towards such a situation? Elaborate. (UPSC GS-I 2024, Q7, 10 marks, 150 words)

- Demand and thesis: Demographic winter describes sustained sub-replacement fertility, ageing, smaller entrant cohorts and eventual natural decline; it is emerging in several regions but is not a uniform global condition.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: WPP 2024 says over half of countries/areas have fertility below 2.1. Replacement varies, and momentum/migration delay decline.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Eastern Asia and Europe combine very low fertility with high median ages, increasing care, pension and labour-supply pressures; country policy and migration differ.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: Sub-Saharan Africa remains youthful and high-growth overall, so the world contains opposite demographic regimes.

- Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification: India is internally staggered: SRS 2023 TFR 1.9 masks Bihar 2.8 and Delhi 1.2, while WPP medium projects national growth to about 2061.

- Qualification: The term is not an official stage or fixed threshold and can obscure longevity gains, productivity adaptation and silver-economy opportunities.

- Verdict: The world is moving toward demographic winter in parts, while the global whole remains a mosaic of decline, momentum and youthful growth.

- Why this earns marks: It defines, evaluates scale with named evidence, applies India, explains momentum and ends with a graded global verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

The world is moving toward demographic winter in parts, while the global whole remains a mosaic of decline, momentum and youthful growth.

STUDY LINK

Low fertility, WPP regions, ageing and India.

HIGH

Verified Prelims PYQ 5 - UPSC 2024 Q41: Total Fertility Rate

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

The total fertility rate in an economy is defined as:

KEY DATA

Option	Authentic option
A	the number of children born per 1000 people in the population in a year.
B	the number of children born to a couple in their lifetime in a given population.
C	the birth rate minus death rate.
D	the average number of live births a woman would have by the end of her child-bearing age.

STATIC THEORY

- Official Set-A key: D.
- D is the exam's concise expression of a synthetic period measure derived from current age-specific fertility rates.
- A is crude birth rate; C is a crude natural-increase concept; B incorrectly turns TFR into actual completed couple fertility.
- Advanced qualification: the precise TFR definition assumes current age-specific rates persist through a synthetic woman's reproductive ages; it is not a prediction for any individual woman.
- Key status: OFFICIALLY VERIFIED. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED not required.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

- 1. Authentic wording and option order retained.
- 2. TFR denominator logic is women by reproductive age, not total population.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Select B because it sounds like family size.
CORRECT: TFR is period synthetic-cohort fertility, not completed couple fertility.

MAINS ANGLE

Use this definition before any replacement-fertility or demographic-winter analysis.

STUDY LINK

UPSC 2024 Prelims GS-I Set A and official key.

HIGH

Verified Prelims PYQ 6 - UPSC 2024 Q67: Low birth rates, ageing or decline

GS-I Geography

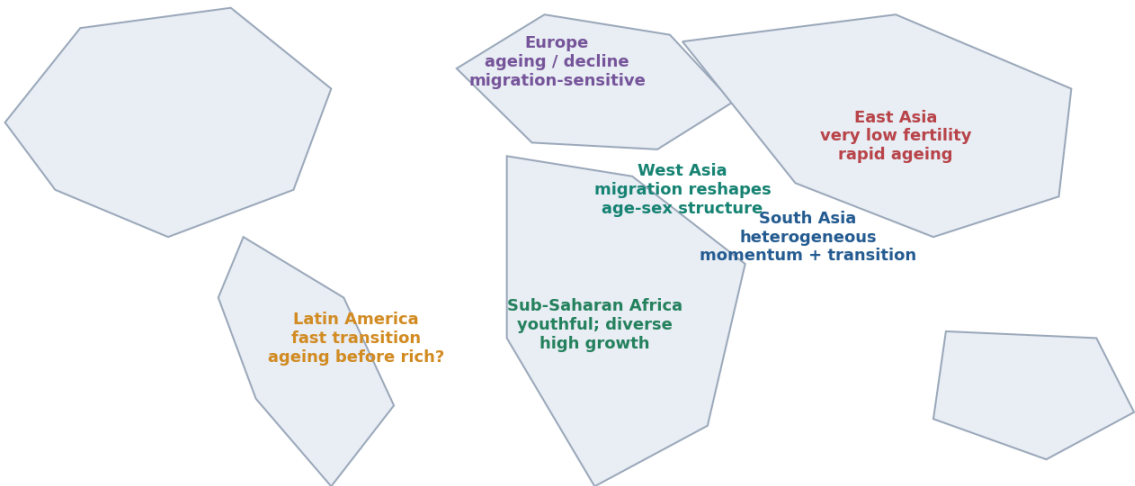
INTRO & ORIGIN

Consider the following countries: 1. Italy 2. Japan 3. Nigeria 4. South Korea 5. South Africa. Which are frequently mentioned in the media for low birth rates, ageing population or declining population?

ORIGINAL VISUAL

Regional Demographic Mosaic

WPP 2024 mid-2024/long-run pattern; regions contain large internal diversity.



Small states, conflict contexts and migration hubs can diverge sharply from regional averages; avoid continent-wide homogenisation.

Regional orientation for the country-set question.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

KEY DATA

Option	Authentic combination
A	1, 2 and 4
B	1, 3 and 5
C	2 and 4 only
D	3 and 5 only

STATIC THEORY

- Official Set-A key: A.
- Italy, Japan and South Korea are the intended low-fertility/ageing/decline set. Nigeria remains youthful and high-fertility; South Africa does not belong to the same media pattern in the exam-year frame.
- C omits Italy, which is a prominent European low-fertility and ageing case.
- Current-source discipline: later WPP updates can enrich explanation but do not rewrite the official 2024 key.
- Key status: OFFICIALLY VERIFIED. INFERRED ANSWER - NOT OFFICIALLY VERIFIED not required.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Authentic sequence and option order retained.
2. Regional averages are not substitutes for country-level classification.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose only East Asian cases.

CORRECT: The question includes Italy's European ageing/decline pattern.

MAINS ANGLE

Convert the item into a map contrasting low-fertility ageing regions with youthful high-growth regions.

STUDY LINK

UPSC 2024 Prelims GS-I Set A and official key.

HIGH**MCQ Q1 - Data vocabulary****GS-I Geography****INTRO & ORIGIN**

Which statement best distinguishes a projection from a forecast?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A projection is a conditional future path under stated assumptions; a forecast adds a judgement about the most likely path.
B	A projection is any census result.
C	A forecast never uses assumptions.
D	Both terms always mean the same thing.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. A projection is a conditional future path under stated assumptions; a forecast adds a judgement about the most likely path.
- Projection variants show consequences of assumptions. A forecast additionally claims relative likelihood or expected outcome.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q1: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Data vocabulary.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q2 - Census concepts**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

A de jure census primarily counts people according to:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Where they are physically found on census night only.
B	Their usual or legal place of residence.
C	Their place of birth only.
D	Their current workplace only.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Their usual or legal place of residence.
- De facto counting follows place of enumeration; de jure counting follows usual residence, subject to the census definition.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q2: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Census concepts.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q3 - Data comparability**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why can two official estimates of the same indicator differ?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	One must therefore be fabricated.
B	Official estimates cannot be revised.
C	They may use different reference periods, denominators, samples, adjustments or revisions.
D	Only rounding can create a difference.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. They may use different reference periods, denominators, samples, adjustments or revisions.
- Demographic estimates are constructed from instruments with different coverage and model assumptions.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q3: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: Data comparability.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q4 - Density measures**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Physiological density is calculated as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Farm population divided by total land.
B	Urban population divided by built-up floor area.
C	Output divided by workers.
D	Total population divided by arable land.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Total population divided by arable land.
- It better approximates pressure on cultivable land than arithmetic density but remains sensitive to how arable land is defined.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q4: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Density measures.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q5 - Density interpretation**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about high arithmetic density is most defensible?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It does not by itself prove overpopulation because productivity, trade, services and institutions mediate welfare.
B	It always proves food scarcity.
C	It always indicates environmental collapse.
D	It means physiological density must be low.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. It does not by itself prove overpopulation because productivity, trade, services and institutions mediate welfare.
- Overpopulation is a relational welfare concept, not a direct synonym for persons per square kilometre.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q5: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Density interpretation.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q6 - Growth arithmetic

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

If births exceed deaths but emigration exceeds immigration by a still larger amount, total population can:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Only grow.
B	Decline even while natural increase is positive.
C	Remain unaffected by migration.
D	Have a negative birth rate.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Decline even while natural increase is positive.
- Total change equals natural change plus net migration; the migration term can outweigh positive natural increase.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q6: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Growth arithmetic.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q7 - Doubling time

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

A population growing at a constant 2 per cent annually has a Rule-of-70 doubling-time approximation of:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	About 14 years.
B	Exactly 70 years.
C	About 35 years.
D	About 140 years.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. About 35 years.
- $70 / 2$ is about 35, but the approximation assumes a roughly constant positive rate.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q7: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: Doubling time.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q8 - Fertility concepts**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the best description of TFR?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Annual births per 1,000 total population.
B	Actual completed family size of all women alive.
C	Surviving daughters per newborn girl.
D	The number of births a synthetic cohort of women would have if current age-specific fertility rates persisted through reproductive ages.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. The number of births a synthetic cohort of women would have if current age-specific fertility rates persisted through reproductive ages.
- TFR is a period measure constructed from ASFRs; it is not a direct cohort count.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q8: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Fertility concepts.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q9 - Reproduction rates**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

NRR differs from GRR because NRR:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Allows for female mortality before and through reproductive ages.
B	Counts sons instead of daughters.
C	Uses only crude birth rates.
D	Is always exactly TFR divided by two.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Allows for female mortality before and through reproductive ages.
- Both concern daughters, but NRR estimates surviving daughters and equals about one at replacement under the measured schedule.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q9: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Reproduction rates.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q10 - Population momentum

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Below-replacement TFR does not necessarily cause immediate decline because:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Death rates become zero.
B	A large cohort entering reproductive ages can sustain births through population momentum.
C	Migration ceases automatically.
D	Replacement fertility is always 1.0.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. A large cohort entering reproductive ages can sustain births through population momentum.
- Age structure stores the effect of past fertility; total births depend on both rates and numbers of women at each age.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q10: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Population momentum.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q11 - Tempo versus quantum

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is a tempo change rather than a quantum change?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Women complete fewer births over their lifetimes.
B	Infant mortality declines.
C	Women postpone births to later ages while eventually having the same completed number of children.
D	Net migration becomes positive.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Women postpone births to later ages while eventually having the same completed number of children.
- Tempo concerns timing; quantum concerns completed fertility. Postponement can temporarily depress period TFR.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q11: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: Tempo versus quantum.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q12 - Replacement fertility**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is replacement-level fertility not universally exactly 2.1?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It is legally fixed by the UN.
B	It equals the crude death rate.
C	It changes only with migration.
D	It varies with female mortality and the sex ratio at birth.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. It varies with female mortality and the sex ratio at birth.
- Higher mortality before/during reproductive ages requires more births for cohort replacement; sex composition also matters.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q12: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Replacement fertility.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q13 - Mortality indicators

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

A crude death rate can be higher in a healthier ageing society than in a younger poorer society because:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A larger elderly share raises deaths per total population even if age-specific mortality is lower.
B	Life expectancy and CDR are identical.
C	Age structure never affects crude rates.
D	Healthier societies must have higher infant mortality.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. A larger elderly share raises deaths per total population even if age-specific mortality is lower.
- Crude rates are composition-sensitive; age-standardised or age-specific rates are better for comparison.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q13: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Mortality indicators.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q14 - Maternal mortality

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Maternal mortality ratio uses which denominator?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Total female population.
B	Live births.
C	All pregnancies only.
D	Women aged 15-49 only.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Live births.
- MMR is maternal deaths per stated number of live births; it is called a ratio because numerator and denominator refer to different populations.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q14: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Maternal mortality.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q15 - HALE****GS-I** Geography**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Healthy life expectancy differs from ordinary life expectancy because it:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Counts only people with insurance.
B	Is always higher.
C	Adjusts expected years for time lived in less than full health.
D	Measures only infant survival.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Adjusts expected years for time lived in less than full health.
- HALE adds morbidity/disability to mortality, making longevity quality explicit.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q15: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: HALE.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q16 - Population pyramids**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which pyramid inference is safest?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Shape alone fixes the next century.
B	A broad base guarantees a dividend.
C	A constrictive pyramid proves zero migration.
D	A narrow base suggests recent low fertility, but migration and future behaviour must be assessed before forecasting decline.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. A narrow base suggests recent low fertility, but migration and future behaviour must be assessed before forecasting decline.

- Pyramids diagnose current structure; they do not replace assumptions about future fertility, mortality and migration.

- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q16: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Population pyramids.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q17 - Dependency ratios

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

The demographic dependency ratio is best understood as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	An age-structure ratio that does not reveal actual employment or care intensity by itself.
B	A direct unemployment rate.
C	A measure of national income.
D	The share of migrants in a city.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. An age-structure ratio that does not reveal actual employment or care intensity by itself.
- Some working-age people do not work and some older people do; economic dependency differs from demographic dependency.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q17: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Dependency ratios.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

MCQ Q18 - DTM Stage 2

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

The central mechanism of DTM Stage 2 is:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Both rates rise.
B	Mortality falls while fertility remains high, widening natural increase.
C	Fertility falls before mortality.
D	Migration becomes the only growth component.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Mortality falls while fertility remains high, widening natural increase.
- The growth surge reflects the lag between mortality and fertility decline.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q18: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: DTM Stage 2.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q19 - DTM limitations**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is DTM not a universal timetable?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It excludes births and deaths.
B	It applies only to cities.
C	It generalises a historical European sequence, while later transitions differ in speed, causes, migration and policy context.
D	Every country must remain in Stage 2.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. It generalises a historical European sequence, while later transitions differ in speed, causes, migration and policy context.
- DTM is a descriptive framework; imported medicine, state policy and gender change can alter sequencing.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q19: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: DTM limitations.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q20 - DTM Stage 5**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Stage 5 should be treated as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A universally accepted original stage.
B	A synonym for epidemiological transition.
C	A stage defined only by immigration.
D	A debated extension used for sustained very low fertility, ageing and possible decline.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. A debated extension used for sustained very low fertility, ageing and possible decline.
- The classic model had four stages; Stage 5 is useful but contested and should be labelled accordingly.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q20: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: DTM Stage 5.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q21 - Epidemiological transition**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Epidemiological transition mainly explains changes in:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	The dominant causes and age pattern of mortality and morbidity.
B	Settlement hierarchy.
C	International migrant stock.
D	Arithmetic density.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. The dominant causes and age pattern of mortality and morbidity.
- It complements DTM but addresses disease and mortality composition, including mixed burdens.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q21: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Epidemiological transition.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q22 - Mobility transition**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Zelinsky's mobility transition proposes that:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Migration determines the global population total.
B	Forms and intensity of mobility tend to change with wider modernisation and demographic transition.
C	All migration becomes international.
D	Distance no longer matters.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Forms and intensity of mobility tend to change with wider modernisation and demographic transition.
- It links transitions in mobility to societal change, but is broad-brush and non-deterministic.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q22: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Mobility transition.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q23 - Population-resource theories**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which synthesis of Malthus and Boserup is strongest?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Malthus simply failed and is irrelevant.
B	Boserup proves resources are unlimited.
C	Scarcity risk and innovation can coexist; institutions, distribution and ecological limits determine outcomes.
D	Both deny technology.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Scarcity risk and innovation can coexist; institutions, distribution and ecological limits determine outcomes.
- Technological intensification has raised output, but local ecological limits and entitlement failures remain real.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q23: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: Population-resource theories.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q24 - Structural theory**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

A structural or Marxist critique of population scarcity emphasises:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Population size is never relevant.
B	Technology cannot change output.
C	Only climate explains famine.
D	Ownership, distribution and power can produce deprivation even when aggregate resources are adequate.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Ownership, distribution and power can produce deprivation even when aggregate resources are adequate.
- It shifts analysis from arithmetic scarcity to access and political economy without denying biophysical limits.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q24: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Structural theory.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q25 - Fertility drivers****GS-I** Geography**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Which fertility-transition claim avoids single-factor determinism?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Female education interacts with survival, employment, norms, contraception, housing costs and social security.
B	Urbanisation alone always lowers TFR.
C	Contraception alone explains every transition.
D	Employment always raises fertility.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Female education interacts with survival, employment, norms, contraception, housing costs and social security.
- Drivers operate through interacting pathways whose strength varies by context.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q25: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Fertility drivers.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q26 - Child survival and fertility**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

The child-survival pathway can lower fertility because:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	It mechanically fixes ideal family size.
B	Parents may need fewer births to achieve a desired number of surviving children.
C	It eliminates gender norms.
D	It increases infant mortality.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Parents may need fewer births to achieve a desired number of surviving children.
- Survival changes reproductive insurance, but norms, contraception and costs mediate the response.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q26: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Child survival and fertility.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q27 - First dividend**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

The first demographic dividend arises mainly from:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	An automatic increase in TFR.
B	Population decline alone.
C	A temporary rise in the working-age share relative to dependants.
D	A census revision.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. A temporary rise in the working-age share relative to dependants.
- The arithmetic opportunity must be converted through employment and productivity.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q27: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: First dividend.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q28 - Second dividend**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

The second demographic dividend is associated with:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Only more births.
B	Only immigration.
C	A higher child dependency ratio.
D	Savings, capital deepening and human-capital investment prompted partly by longer lives and retirement needs.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Savings, capital deepening and human-capital investment prompted partly by longer lives and retirement needs.
- It is not automatic and depends on financial systems, security and investment behaviour.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q28: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Second dividend.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q29 - Youth bulge****GS-I** Geography**INTRO & ORIGIN**

A youth bulge is best described as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	A conditional opportunity or risk whose outcome depends on jobs, inclusion, education and institutions.
B	A direct cause of conflict.
C	A guarantee of innovation.
D	A synonym for high density.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. A conditional opportunity or risk whose outcome depends on jobs, inclusion, education and institutions.
- Age structure changes the scale of policy needs but does not predetermine social outcomes.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q29: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Youth bulge.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q30 - Ageing policy****GS-I** Geography**INTRO & ORIGIN**

Which response treats ageing as more than a burden?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Reduce all elder spending.
B	Combine healthy ageing, flexible work, care infrastructure, productivity and silver-economy opportunities.
C	Assume families can provide all care.
D	Use pronatalism alone.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Combine healthy ageing, flexible work, care infrastructure, productivity and silver-economy opportunities.
- Ageing is an achievement of survival as well as a pension, care and workforce challenge.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q30: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Ageing policy.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q31 - Feminisation of ageing**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Feminisation of ageing refers primarily to:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Higher female births only.
B	Women's share of migration only.
C	Women's greater representation at older ages, often combined with widowhood and economic vulnerability.
D	A fall in female life expectancy.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Women's greater representation at older ages, often combined with widowhood and economic vulnerability.
- Longer female survival and life-course inequality make gender central to elder policy.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q31: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: Feminisation of ageing.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q32 - Regional patterns**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which regional statement is most accurate?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Every African country has identical TFR.
B	Europe has no youthful subregions.
C	South Asia is uniformly at replacement.
D	Sub-Saharan Africa is generally youthful and high-growth but contains wide country variation.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Sub-Saharan Africa is generally youthful and high-growth but contains wide country variation.
- Regional averages are useful orientations, not substitutes for country or subnational evidence.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q32: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Regional patterns.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q33 - Migration and age structure**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why can West Asian age-sex structures be unusual?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Large temporary labour-migrant stocks can reshape working-age and sex composition.
B	Migration changes the global total.
C	Fertility has no effect.
D	All migrants are permanent settlers.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. Large temporary labour-migrant stocks can reshape working-age and sex composition.
- Migration redistributes population and selectively changes destination composition.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q33: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Migration and age structure.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q34 - Population policy****GS-I Geography****INTRO & ORIGIN**

Which population policy is most consistent with reproductive rights?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Compulsory sterilisation targets.
B	Voluntary informed choice, method mix, quality services and freedom from coercion.
C	Punitive denial of welfare.
D	A universal one-child mandate.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Voluntary informed choice, method mix, quality services and freedom from coercion.
- Rights-based family planning protects agency while addressing unmet need and health.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q34: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Population policy.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q35 - Migration arithmetic**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why does migration not change the global population total directly?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Migrants stop ageing.
B	Migration has no local effect.
C	Every international immigrant is also an emigrant from another country.
D	All migration is internal.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Every international immigrant is also an emigrant from another country.
- Migration redistributes people among territories; births and deaths change the global total.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q35: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: Migration arithmetic.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**MCQ Q36 - Migration stock and flow**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

A current international migrant stock is:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	All border crossings during a year.
B	Net migration during a decade.
C	Only refugees.
D	People meeting a residence-based migrant definition at a reference date.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. People meeting a residence-based migrant definition at a reference date.
- Stock and flow differ; repeated movements and departures mean flows cannot be read as resident stocks.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q36: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Migration stock and flow.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q37 - India fertility divergence**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which India statement follows SRS 2023?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	National TFR was 1.9, but major-state variation ranged from Delhi 1.2 to Bihar 2.8.
B	Every state had TFR 1.9.
C	The figure is a Census count.
D	India's population immediately declined.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. National TFR was 1.9, but major-state variation ranged from Delhi 1.2 to Bihar 2.8.
- SRS is a sample-based vital-statistics system; the national rate masks staggered state transitions.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q37: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: India fertility divergence.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q38 - India data literacy**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why can NFHS-6 TFR 2.0 and SRS 2023 TFR 1.9 both be official?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	One must be a census count.
B	They use different instruments, reference designs and estimation procedures.
C	TFR cannot be revised.
D	The indicators have different definitions.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. They use different instruments, reference designs and estimation procedures.
- Comparable concepts can yield different estimates when surveys, periods, samples and adjustments differ.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q38: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: India data literacy.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q39 - India census status**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which Census 2027 statement is correct as of 19 August 2026?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Census 2027 results are already final.
B	NFHS-6 is the new census.
C	The reference date is scheduled for 1 March 2027 generally and 1 October 2026 for specified snow-bound areas; no new all-India count is yet available.
D	WPP 2024 is an Indian census.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. The reference date is scheduled for 1 March 2027 generally and 1 October 2026 for specified snow-bound areas; no new all-India count is yet available.
- Phase I runs in state-selected windows in 2026; Population Enumeration is scheduled later.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q39: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: India census status.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q40 - WPP India**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

WPP 2024's medium-variant India figure for mid-2024 should be labelled as:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	The final Census 2024 total.
B	A monthly live counter.
C	A PLFS estimate.
D	A UN WPP medium-variant projection for 1 July 2024, about 1.451 billion, not a census count.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. A UN WPP medium-variant projection for 1 July 2024, about 1.451 billion, not a census count.
- WPP 2024's projection period begins in 2024; reference date, revision and variant must travel with the number.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q40: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: WPP India.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q41 - Projection uncertainty**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which statement about WPP high and low variants is safest?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	They are alternative fertility sensitivity scenarios, not automatically probabilistic confidence bounds.
B	High is a guaranteed maximum.
C	Low is a census underestimate.
D	Medium contains no assumptions.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: A. They are alternative fertility sensitivity scenarios, not automatically probabilistic confidence bounds.
- Scenario variants and probabilistic uncertainty intervals answer different questions.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q41: expected key A.
2. Subtopic tested: Projection uncertainty.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q42 - Population and environment**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

A population-environment answer using IPAT should:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Blame population size alone.
B	Treat population, consumption and technology as interacting, then add inequality, urban form and institutions.
C	Treat IPAT as a complete causal law.
D	Ignore per-capita consumption.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: B. Treat population, consumption and technology as interacting, then add inequality, urban form and institutions.
- IPAT is a heuristic/accounting identity; STIRPAT-type estimates remain model-sensitive.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q42: expected key B.
2. Subtopic tested: Population and environment.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q43 - Lifecycle policy**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Which is the best lifecycle policy sequence?

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Fertility targets only.
B	Pensions before child survival only.
C	Maternal-child health -> learning and gender equality -> skills/jobs -> social protection/care -> active ageing.
D	Urban planning without migration data.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: C. Maternal-child health -> learning and gender equality -> skills/jobs -> social protection/care -> active ageing.
- Population policy must follow cohorts through life and vary by regional transition stage.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q43: expected key C.
2. Subtopic tested: Lifecycle policy.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH**Remedial MCQ Q44 - Monitoring indicators**

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

A demographic-dividend dashboard is incomplete without:

KEY DATA

Option	Choice
A	Only the working-age share.
B	Only total population.
C	Only arithmetic density.
D	Employment quality, productivity, learning, health, nutrition and female participation indicators.

STATIC THEORY

- Answer: D. Employment quality, productivity, learning, health, nutrition and female participation indicators.
- Age structure measures opportunity; conversion outcomes show whether a dividend is realised.
- Elimination check: reject each distractor by the exact definition, denominator, reference period, spatial boundary or scenario label used in the stem.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Continuous rotation position Q44: expected key D.
2. Subtopic tested: Monitoring indicators.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Choose a familiar demographic word without checking its denominator.

CORRECT: Identify unit, time, population at risk and whether the measure is a stock, flow or rate.

MAINS ANGLE

Turn the explanation into a two-sentence definition plus qualification.

STUDY LINK

Geography 26 complete topic package.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Original 10-marker A

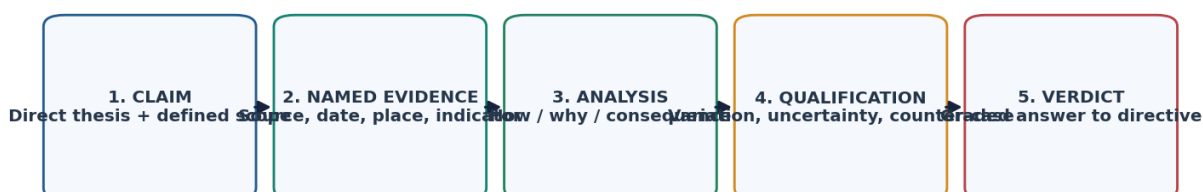
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Differentiate arithmetic, physiological and agricultural density. Explain why high density need not mean overpopulation. (Original, 10 marks, 150 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Differentiate arithmetic, physiological and agricultural density. Explain why high density need not mean overpopulation. (Original, 10 marks, 150 words)
- Demand and thesis: The three densities change the denominator and therefore diagnose different forms of spatial pressure; none directly measures welfare or ecological overshoot.
- Claim -> formula -> analysis -> qualification: Arithmetic density is total population/total land and is useful for broad comparison; it masks deserts, mountains and arable concentration.
- Claim -> formula -> analysis -> qualification: Physiological density is total population/arable land and approximates food-land pressure; yields, diets, trade and arable definitions vary.
- Claim -> formula -> analysis -> qualification: Agricultural density is agricultural population/arable land and indicates farm-labour intensity; mechanisation and occupational classification alter meaning.
- Claim -> example -> analysis -> qualification: High-density trade and service economies can sustain high welfare through productivity, imports and infrastructure, while low-density fragile regions can face scarcity through access and ecological limits.
- Qualification: Overpopulation depends on resources, technology, consumption, institutions and desired living standards, not a universal density threshold.
- Verdict: Density should be read as a diagnostic ratio, while overpopulation is a contextual welfare-resource relation.
- Why this earns marks: It gives all formulas, uses each measure analytically, rejects a common equivalence and ends with a precise conceptual verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

Density should be read as a diagnostic ratio, while overpopulation is a contextual welfare-resource relation.

STUDY LINK

Density, carrying capacity and economic geography.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Original 10-marker B

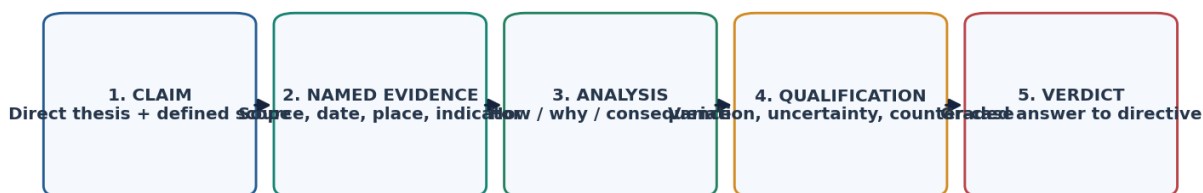
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Why is the Demographic Transition Model useful yet non-universal? Discuss with complementary transition theories.
(Original, 10 marks, 150 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Why is the Demographic Transition Model useful yet non-universal? Discuss with complementary transition theories. (Original, 10 marks, 150 words)

- Demand and thesis: DTM usefully isolates the mortality-fertility lag that creates growth, but its European sequence cannot serve as a universal timetable.

- Claim -> evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification: Stage 2's falling mortality before fertility explains rapid natural increase and changing dependency; later countries often used imported medical technology at lower incomes.

- Claim -> evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification: Stage 3 links fertility decline to survival, education, urban costs and contraception; driver strength and sequencing vary.

- Claim -> theory -> analysis -> qualification: Epidemiological transition explains changing causes of death and mixed disease burdens, not fertility itself.

- Claim -> theory -> analysis -> qualification: Zelinsky links mobility forms to modernisation, but circular migration, conflict and policy disrupt a fixed sequence.

- Qualification: Migration, shocks, state boundaries and debated Stage 5 outcomes remain weak in the classic model.

- Verdict: DTM is best used as a comparative skeleton completed by epidemiological, mobility and contextual political-economy analysis.

- Why this earns marks: It explains the model's mechanism, supplies two complementary theories, identifies origin bias and provides a balanced use verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

DTM is best used as a comparative skeleton completed by epidemiological, mobility and contextual political-economy analysis.

STUDY LINK

DTM, epidemiological and mobility transitions.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Original 15-marker A

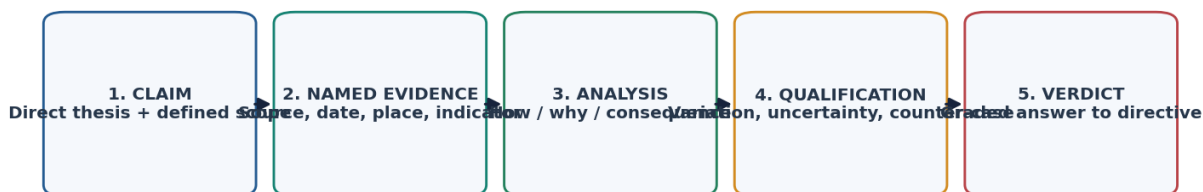
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Compare Malthusian, Boserupian and structural explanations of population-resource stress. (Original, 15 marks, 250 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Compare Malthusian, Boserupian and structural explanations of population-resource stress. (Original, 15 marks, 250 words)

- Demand and thesis: The perspectives explain different margins - biophysical pressure, induced innovation and unequal access - and are strongest when synthesised rather than treated as mutually exclusive prophecies.

- Claim -> named theory -> analysis -> qualification: Malthus highlights lagged subsistence and checks when population pressure rises. Modern yield growth and fertility transition refute a timeless arithmetic inevitability, but local thresholds and investment lags preserve relevance.

- Claim -> named theory/example -> analysis -> qualification: Boserup argues pressure induces intensification and innovation, visible in multiple cropping and yield-raising systems; energy, water, labour and ecological costs mean response is not unlimited.

- Claim -> named theory/example -> analysis -> qualification: Structural/Marxist and entitlement perspectives show ownership, wages, trade and state power can produce hunger without aggregate shortage; access analysis should not erase biophysical constraints.

- Claim -> contemporary frame -> analysis -> qualification: IPAT connects population with consumption and technology, while inequality and urban form explain why impacts are uneven; it is a heuristic, not a complete causal model.

- Qualification: Scale matters: global food availability can coexist with household deprivation and local aquifer/biodiversity limits.

- Verdict: A contemporary synthesis combines ecological ceilings, innovative capacity and distributive institutions instead of declaring one historical theory victorious.

- Why this earns marks: It compares mechanisms and criticisms, gives contemporary mediation, handles scale and reaches an integrated critical judgement.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

A contemporary synthesis combines ecological ceilings, innovative capacity and distributive institutions instead of declaring one historical theory victorious.

STUDY LINK

Population-resource theory, food security and environment.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Original 15-marker B

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Assess the causes and consequences of India's subnational demographic divergence. (Original, 15 marks, 250 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Assess the causes and consequences of India's subnational demographic divergence. (Original, 15 marks, 250 words)
- Demand and thesis: India's state demographic clocks diverge because survival, education, gender, urbanisation, social policy and migration changed at different speeds; the consequence is simultaneous youth, mobility and ageing agendas.
- Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification: SRS 2023 TFR ranges from Bihar 2.8 and Uttar Pradesh 2.6 to Delhi 1.2, Tamil Nadu/West Bengal 1.3 and Maharashtra 1.4. SRS is sample evidence, and destination migration affects city-state structure.
- Claim -> mechanism -> analysis -> qualification: Earlier child-survival gains, female education, urbanisation and service access accelerated southern/western transitions; no single driver explains all state variation.
- Claim -> consequence -> analysis -> qualification: Younger north-central cohorts expand school, health and job demand; the window yields a dividend only with nutrition, learning and productive employment.
- Claim -> consequence -> analysis -> qualification: Earlier-ageing states face chronic disease, pension and long-term-care pressure, while smaller entrant cohorts can support greater per-child investment and automation.
- Claim -> migration example -> analysis -> qualification: Worker movement connects youthful origins with labour-demand destinations but raises housing, portability, language and family-care issues.
- Qualification: National averages and one dividend end-year conceal district, social-group and rural-urban differences.
- Verdict: India needs fiscal and service federalism organised around state-specific cohort needs, with safe migration connecting rather than polarising the clocks.
- Why this earns marks: It uses current SRS evidence correctly, explains multiple causes, derives both youth and ageing consequences, and proposes a spatially differentiated verdict.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

India needs fiscal and service federalism organised around state-specific cohort needs, with safe migration connecting rather than polarising the clocks.

STUDY LINK

India transition, federalism, migration and ageing.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Original 20-marker A

GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Population projections are decision tools, not demographic destiny. Critically examine with reference to World Population Prospects 2024. (Original, 20 marks, 250 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Population projections are decision tools, not demographic destiny. Critically examine with reference to World Population Prospects 2024. (Original, 20 marks, 250 words)
- Demand and thesis: WPP 2024 provides a coherent conditional baseline and uncertainty architecture, but every path depends on revised historical estimates and future fertility, mortality and migration assumptions.
- Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification: The medium variant places the world at 8.162 billion on 1 July 2024 and projects a peak of 10.289 billion in 2084. This central path is not an observed future.
- Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification: World 2100 low/high fertility scenarios span about 6.987 to 14.395 billion, showing compounding fertility sensitivity; these are not automatically probability bounds.
- Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification: India's medium path rises from 1.451 billion in 2024 to about 1.701 billion in 2061 before declining; 2024 is WPP's first projection year and neither figure is a census count.
- Claim -> mechanism -> analysis -> qualification: Near-term paths are anchored by cohorts already alive; WPP attributes 79% of global increase through 2054 to momentum. Migration and shocks can still alter national paths.
- Claim -> data literacy -> analysis -> qualification: New censuses, registers and surveys revise baselines, making revisions evidence of learning; low-quality input data widen uncertainty.
- Policy analysis: use scenario ranges for schools, jobs, housing, pensions and climate stress tests; publish assumptions and update decisions rather than target one number.
- Qualification: A projection can be robust for direction and cohort planning while uncertain in distant magnitude; confidence varies by horizon and component.
- Verdict: The correct use of WPP is adaptive planning across labelled scenarios, not deterministic prediction or conversion of estimates into census facts.
- Why this earns marks: It uses exact dated scenario evidence, distinguishes variant from probability and estimate from projection, explains momentum/revision and converts uncertainty into policy.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

The correct use of WPP is adaptive planning across labelled scenarios, not deterministic prediction or conversion of estimates into census facts.

STUDY LINK

WPP methods, data literacy and planning.

HIGH

Solved Mains - Original 20-marker B

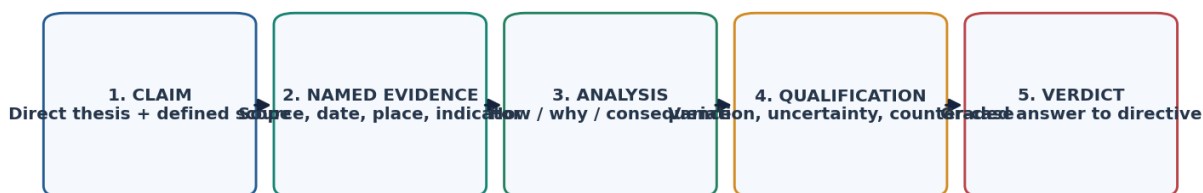
GS-I Geography

INTRO & ORIGIN

Design a rights-based lifecycle population policy for India amid simultaneous youth growth, low fertility and ageing. (Original, 20 marks, 250 words)

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Reusable examiner-grade population answer sequence.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

STATIC THEORY

- Question: Design a rights-based lifecycle population policy for India amid simultaneous youth growth, low fertility and ageing. (Original, 20 marks, 250 words)
- Demand and thesis: India requires enabling policy differentiated by state demographic clock, not coercive national population control.
- Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification: SRS 2023's national TFR 1.9 masks Bihar 2.8 and Delhi 1.2; state variation demands different service timing, while SRS estimates are not census counts.
- Claim -> lifecycle intervention -> analysis -> qualification: Maternal-child health, nutrition and voluntary method choice reduce preventable death and unmet need; no target should compromise informed consent.
- Claim -> youth intervention -> named evidence -> analysis: Learning, skills, urban housing and productive jobs convert cohorts. PLFS June 2026 CWS female LFPR 32.7% marks a conversion bottleneck, but reference-period differences require cautious comparison.
- Claim -> gender/aspiration intervention -> evidence -> qualification: Childcare, safe work, housing and infertility/reproductive services enable desired families. UNFPA's 2025-26 internet-connected youth survey informs aspirations but is not nationally representative.
- Claim -> ageing intervention -> analysis -> qualification: Pensions, primary/geriatric care, long-term care, accessible cities, flexible work and care-work formalisation convert longevity into capability; pronatal incentives act too slowly to replace these systems.
- Claim -> spatial architecture -> analysis: Portable benefits and affordable rental housing connect youthful labour-origin states to ageing destination economies while protecting migrant rights.
- Monitoring: fertility, mortality, migration and age structure plus learning, nutrition, job quality, female participation, productivity, urban services, care coverage and data quality.
- Qualification: Rights-based policy still requires fiscal prioritisation and evaluation; voluntarism is compatible with active capability-building, not policy withdrawal.
- Verdict: India should replace one-number control with a federal lifecycle compact that enables reproductive agency, productive mobility and dignified ageing.
- Why this earns marks: It integrates all demographic regimes, uses three current sources with limits, centres rights, provides lifecycle institutions and ends with measurable federal policy.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Every paragraph follows claim -> named evidence/example -> analysis -> qualification.
2. The conclusion answers the directive rather than adding a generic slogan.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: List data without explaining what it proves.

CORRECT: Use named evidence only after a clear claim and interpret it.

WRONG: Use a national average as a uniform state fact.

CORRECT: Name the geography, year, instrument and uncertainty.

MAINS ANGLE

India should replace one-number control with a federal lifecycle compact that enables reproductive agency, productive mobility and dignified ageing.

STUDY LINK

India policy, rights, dividend, migration and ageing.

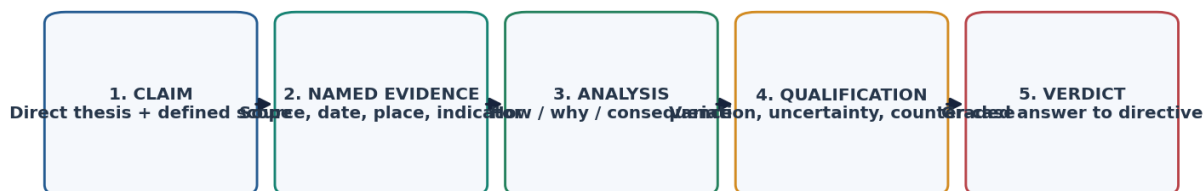
HIGH

Workbook self-audit and revision checklist

GS-I Geography

ORIGINAL VISUAL

UPSC Answer Spine: Claim to Verdict



Population answers score when data type and variant are labelled, mechanisms are spatially differentiated, and coercive or deterministic claims are rejected.

Final examiner-grade answer audit.

Original deterministic schematic prepared for this package; not a substitute for the cited evidence.

KEY DATA

Before submitting	Audit question
Definition	Did I distinguish count/estimate/projection, stock/flow and period/cohort?
Data	Did every number carry source, reference year/date and instrument?
Projection	Did I state WPP 2024, horizon and medium/low/high or probability status?
Causation	Did I avoid one-factor claims and environmental determinism?
India	Did I use state divergence rather than one national stage/window?
Rights	Did I reject coercion and centre reproductive agency?
Mains	Does each paragraph have claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification?
Verdict	Did I answer the directive and state Why this earns marks?

STATIC THEORY

- Prelims: identify denominator, reference period, stock/flow, scenario label and age composition before eliminating options.
- Mains: one map/curve/formula plus two named current anchors is normally stronger than a page of unlabelled statistics.
- Remedial trigger: revisit the relevant visual whenever the error is definitional rather than factual.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Original MCQs Q1-Q44 are rotated A -> B -> C -> D without repetition breaks.
2. Verified PYQ keys remain in authentic option order.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: Memorise numbers without status.

CORRECT: Attach instrument, date and scenario to every datum.

MAINS ANGLE

Final spine: define -> map mechanism -> evidence -> qualification -> differentiated policy -> verdict.

STUDY LINK

All 24 visuals and final register notes in the main package.

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI